

Lab: Moving from the Inside Out

Objective

Explore embodied action through mindfulness practice that reveals how movement arises from inner impulse, engages with environmental affordances, and unfolds through the sensorimotor loop, through the lens of breath, heartbeat, embodied being.

Prerequisites

- A quiet, comfortable space for 25 minutes
- Willingness to engage in mindfulness practice
- No prior experience required

Part 1: Arriving (5 minutes)

Sit comfortably and close your eyes. Take three slow breaths, letting each exhale be longer than the inhale. Bring your attention to the natural rhythm of your breathing without trying to change it.

Do not decide to move. Wait for your body to want to move. When the impulse comes, follow it. Let the body lead.

Write your response here

(What was the first impulse? Where in your body did it begin? What was the quality of the movement that followed?)

Part 2: Affordances (7 minutes)

Through breath, heartbeat, embodied being, explore how the environment invites action. Look around your space. Notice what each surface, object, and opening offers your body. Follow at least three affordances -- sit, lean, reach, grasp.

Write your response here

(List three affordances you noticed. How did your body and the environment cooperate to produce action?)

Part 3: Effort and Flow (7 minutes)

Perform a familiar action the natural way (flowing). Then try it an awkward way (effortful). Through breath, heartbeat, embodied being, notice the difference in prediction error.

Write your response here

(Describe the felt difference between flowing and effortful action. What does effort tell you about the body's predictions?)

Part 4: Reflection (5 minutes)

Through breath, heartbeat, embodied being, reflect on what action means.

Write your response here

(Is action something you do, or something that unfolds through you? How does breath, heartbeat, embodied being illuminate the nature of embodied action?)

Reflection Table

Dimension	What I Noticed	Active Inference Connection
Initial awareness		Baseline generative model state
Embodied exploration		Prediction error through direct experience
Breath, heartbeat, embodied being lens		Course-specific perspective on action
Integration		Updated understanding through bodily knowing

Discussion

Consider how breath, heartbeat, embodied being reveals aspects of action that other perspectives might miss. In Active Inference, every perspective changes the precision weighting of different signals, revealing different dimensions of the same underlying process of free energy minimization.